WEALTH ARCHITECT • SAGE EDITION

ZERO-BASED BUDGET BINDER

Every Dollar Assigned Framework: Income Sources, Fixed Bills, Variable Cash Envelopes, Sinking Funds & Zero-Balance Check

FRAMEWORK PILLARS & INCLUDED MODULES

- **1. Every Dollar Assigned Architecture**
  Give every single dollar a deliberate job before the month begins so zero money leaks to impulse.
- **2. Multi-Stream Income & Paycheck Allocation**
  Map W-2 paychecks, side hustle payouts, dividends, and irregular income streams with clarity.
- **3. Fixed Bills & Variable Cash Envelopes**
  Separate non-negotiable fixed overheads from controllable daily variable envelope categories.
- **4. Sinking Funds & Zero-Balance Verification**
  Fund future expenses monthly and verify Income minus Outflows equals exactly $0.00.
- **5. Weekly Check-Ins & End-of-Month Audit**
  Track real-time burn rate every 7 days and reconcile variances for continuous wealth compounding.

PLANNER OWNERSHIP & PRIMARY WEALTH COMMITMENT

OWNER / HOUSEHOLD NAME: _____

START DATE & TARGET CYCLE: _____

PRIMARY #1 FINANCIAL GOAL: _____

REWARD WHEN TARGET IS HIT: _____

ANNUAL ZERO-BASED FINANCIAL MASTER MAP

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DATE / PERIOD:

PROJECTED ANNUAL INCOME	ANNUAL FIXED OVERHEAD	ANNUAL SAVINGS & SINKING	TARGET NET WORTH DELTA
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

MONTH	EST. INCOME	FIXED BILLS	ENVELOPES	SINKING / INVEST	ZERO CHECK
January					☐
February					☐
March					☐
April					☐
May					☐
June					☐
July					☐
August					☐
September					☐
October					☐
November					☐
December					☐
ANNUAL CUMULATIVE TOTALS					

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

INCOME SOURCES & PAYCHECK BREAKDOWN MATRIX

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DATE / PERIOD:

PRIMARY W-2 / SALARY	PARTNER / 2ND STREAM	SIDE HUSTLE / FREELANCE	TOTAL MONTHLY INFLOW
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

PAY DATE	INCOME SOURCE / PAYER	GROSS PAY	TAX / DEDUCT	NET DEPOSIT
TOTAL MONTHLY NET INCOME (ASSIGN TO $0.00)				

IRREGULAR / BONUS / DIVIDEND SOURCE	EXPECTED DATE	NET AMOUNT	ASSIGNED BUCKET
TOTAL VARIABLE INFLOWS			

MONTHLY MASTER ZERO-BASED BUDGET COMMAND

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DATE / PERIOD:

TOTAL NET INCOME (+)	TOTAL PLANNED OUTFLOW (-)	TOTAL ACTUAL OUTFLOW (-)	UNASSIGNED BALANCE ($0)
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ 0.00

MASTER CATEGORY BUCKET	% TARGET	BUDGETED ($)	ACTUAL ($)	VARIANCE ($)
1. Housing & Utilities (Fixed)	25-30%			
2. Transportation & Auto (Fixed)	10-12%			
3. Insurance & Healthcare (Fixed)	5-10%			
4. Groceries & Household (Envelope)	10-12%			
5. Dining & Lifestyle (Envelope)	5-8%			
6. Personal Care & Kids (Envelope)	5%			
7. Sinking Funds (Future Buckets)	8-10%			
8. High-Interest Debt Paydown	10-15%			
9. Emergency Fund Reserve	5-10%			
10. Retirement & Index Investing	15%+			
11. Giving & Charity	5-10%			
12. Buffer / Miscellaneous Roll-over	1-2%			
TOTAL MONTHLY ALLOCATION				

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

FIXED BILLS & NON-NEGOTIABLE OVERHEADS

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DATE / PERIOD:

1ST-15TH FIXED BILLS	16TH-31ST FIXED BILLS	AUTOPAY VERIFIED COUNT	TOTAL FIXED BILLS
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

BILL / VENDOR NAME	DUE DAY	AUTOPAY	BUDGETED	ACTUAL PAID	PAID
Mortgage / Rent Payment		☐			☐
Electric & Gas Utility		☐			☐
Water, Sewer & Trash		☐			☐
High-Speed Fiber Internet		☐			☐
Mobile Phone Plan		☐			☐
Auto Insurance Policy		☐			☐
Health / Term Life Insurance		☐			☐
Childcare / Tuition		☐			☐
Gym / Fitness Membership		☐			☐
Cloud Storage / Core Software		☐			☐
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TOTAL FIXED BILLS OVERHEAD					

SUBSCRIPTION & RECURRING CHARGE AUDIT

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DATE / PERIOD:

ACTIVE SUBSCRIPTIONS	MONTHLY BURN RATE	ANNUALIZED DRAIN (X12)	RECLAIMED VIA CANCELS
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

SUBSCRIPTION / APP SERVICE	CYCLE	COST / MO	ANNUAL COST	VALUE (1-5)	CANCEL?
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TOTAL RECURRING SUBSCRIPTION COMMITMENT					

VARIABLE CASH ENVELOPES: MASTER ALLOCATION

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DATE / PERIOD:

TOTAL ENVELOPE FUNDING	TOTAL SPENT MONTH-TO-DATE	REMAINING ENVELOPE CASH	ROLLOVER TO SINKING/DEBT
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

CASH ENVELOPE CATEGORY	STARTING ($)	SPENT ($)	REMAINING ($)	BURN RATE PROGRESS
Groceries & Supermarket				
Household & Cleaning Supplies				
Fuel, Transit & Parking				
Restaurants & Takeout				
Coffee Shops & Quick Treats				
Personal Care & Grooming				
Clothing & Apparel				
Kids Activities & Allowances				
Pet Food & Vet Care				
Entertainment & Date Nights				
Health, Pharmacy & Vitamins				
Gifts & Hospitality				
Fun Money — Partner A				
Fun Money — Partner B				
TOTAL VARIABLE CASH ENVELOPES				

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

VARIABLE CASH ENVELOPES: DAILY BURN LEDGER

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DATE / PERIOD:

ENVELOPE 1: GROCERIES & SUPERMARKET

Starting Budget: $_____

DATE	MERCHANT / ITEM	SPENT	BAL

ENVELOPE 2: DINING OUT & COFFEE

Starting Budget: $_____

DATE	MERCHANT / ITEM	SPENT	BAL

ENVELOPE 3: FUEL & COMMUTE

Starting Budget: $_____

DATE	MERCHANT / ITEM	SPENT	BAL

ENVELOPE 4: PERSONAL / FUN MONEY

Starting Budget: $_____

DATE	MERCHANT / ITEM	SPENT	BAL

SINKING FUNDS & FUTURE EXPENSE BUCKETS

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DATE / PERIOD:

MONTHLY SINKING DEPOSIT	TOTAL SINKING BALANCE	UPCOMING 90-DAY EXPENSE	HYSA INTEREST EARNED
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

SINKING FUND BUCKET	TARGET ($)	START BAL	+ ADDED	- SPENT	END BAL
Car Maintenance & Tires					
Annual Auto Registration / Ins.					
Home Repairs & Appliances					
Medical, Dental & Optical					
Holiday & Christmas Gifts					
Birthdays & Anniversaries					
Annual Software / Prime / Memberships					
Vacation & Travel Fund					
Back-to-School & Kids Gear					
Property / Quarterly Taxes					
Veterinary Emergency Buffer					
Tech Replacement (Laptop/Phone)					
TOTAL SINKING FUNDS ALLOCATION					

DEBT PAYDOWN & WEALTH INVESTING ALLOCATION

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DATE / PERIOD:

EXTRA DEBT SNOWBALL ($)	EMERGENCY FUND ADD ($)	RETIREMENT / 401K / IRA	TAXABLE BROKERAGE ($)
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

WEALTH / SAVINGS / INVESTMENT VEHICLE	ACCOUNT	PLANNED ($)	ACTUAL ($)	DONE
High-Yield Emergency Reserve (3-6 Mo)				☐
Roth IRA / Backdoor Roth Contribution				☐
401(k) / 403(b) Employer Match + Extra				☐
HSA Triple-Tax-Advantaged Account				☐
Low-Cost S&P 500 / Total Market Index				☐
529 Education / Custodial UTMA				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
TOTAL WEALTH BUILDING TRANSFERS				

CREDITOR / DEBT ACCOUNT	MIN PAYMENT	EXTRA SNOWBALL	NEW BALANCE	PAID
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
TOTAL DEBT ELIMINATION PAYMENTS				

PAYCHECK #1 & #2 ZERO-BALANCE SPLIT WORKSHEET

Zero-Based Budget Binder | SAGE EDITION

DATE / PERIOD:

PAYCHECK #1 ALLOCATION SHEET

Pay Date: _____ **Net Deposit:** $_____

ASSIGNED JOB / BILL / ENVELOPE	AMOUNT	DONE
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		☐

UNASSIGNED = $0.00

PAYCHECK #2 ALLOCATION SHEET

Pay Date: _____ **Net Deposit:** $_____

ASSIGNED JOB / BILL / ENVELOPE	AMOUNT	DONE
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UNASSIGNED = $0.00

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

PAYCHECK #3, #4 & SIDE HUSTLE SPLIT WORKSHEET

Zero-Based Budget Binder | SAGE EDITION

DATE / PERIOD:

PAYCHECK #3 ALLOCATION SHEET

Pay Date: _____ **Net Deposit:** $_____

ASSIGNED JOB / BILL / ENVELOPE	AMOUNT	DONE
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		☐

UNASSIGNED = $0.00

PAYCHECK #4 / SIDE HUSTLE SHEET

Pay Date: _____ **Net Deposit:** $_____

ASSIGNED JOB / BILL / ENVELOPE	AMOUNT	DONE
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		☐

UNASSIGNED = $0.00

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

WEEKLY EXPENSE LEDGER: WEEKS 1 & 2

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DATE / PERIOD:

DATE	WEEK 1 — MERCHANT / DESCRIPTION	ENVELOPE / CATEGORY	AMOUNT ($)	TRACKED
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WEEK 1 TOTAL SPEND

DATE	WEEK 2 — MERCHANT / DESCRIPTION	ENVELOPE / CATEGORY	AMOUNT ($)	TRACKED
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				☐
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				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

WEEK 2 TOTAL SPEND

WEEKLY EXPENSE LEDGER: WEEKS 3 & 4

Zero-Based Budget Binder | SAGE EDITION

DATE / PERIOD:

DATE	WEEK 3 — MERCHANT / DESCRIPTION	ENVELOPE / CATEGORY	AMOUNT ($)	TRACKED
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WEEK 3 TOTAL SPEND

DATE	WEEK 4 — MERCHANT / DESCRIPTION	ENVELOPE / CATEGORY	AMOUNT ($)	TRACKED
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				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

WEEK 4 TOTAL SPEND

ZERO-BALANCE VERIFICATION & ROLLOVER AUDIT

Zero-Based Budget Binder | SAGE EDITION

DATE / PERIOD:

ZERO-BASED EQUATION CHECK: TOTAL INCOME - TOTAL OUTFLOWS = $0.00

Income: $_____ - Outflows (Bills + Envelopes + Sinking + Debt/Invest): $_____ = Unassigned: $ 0.00

ZERO-BALANCE VERIFICATION CHECKLIST	AMOUNT ($)	VERIFIED
1. All Checking & Cash Deposits Reconciled		☐
2. Fixed Bills Paid & Cleared Bank Statement		☐
3. Variable Cash Envelopes Counted & Tallied		☐
4. Sinking Fund Transfers Executed to HYSA		☐
5. Extra Debt Snowball Payment Submitted		☐
6. Retirement & Brokerage Auto-Drafts Confirmed		☐
7. Leftover Envelope Surplus Swept to Goal		☐
8. Final Unassigned Balance Equals Exactly $0.00		☐
		☐
		☐

CATEGORY WITH SURPLUS OR OVERAGE	VARIANCE (+/-)	REASSIGNED TO / COVERED FROM

NET VARIANCE ADJUSTMENT = $0.00

MONTHLY BUDGET RETROSPECTIVE & NEXT MONTH RESET

DATE / PERIOD:

SAVINGS RATE (%)	DEBT PAID OFF ($)	NET WORTH CHANGE (+)	ZERO-BASED GRADE (A-F)
$ _____	$ _____	$ _____	$ _____

1. TOP 3 FINANCIAL WINS THIS MONTH:

2. BIGGEST BUDGET LEAKS OR UNEXPECTED EXPENSES TO ANTICIPATE:

3. CATEGORIES TO ADJUST UP OR DOWN FOR NEXT MONTH:

4. NEXT MONTH NON-NEGOTIABLE #1 MONEY PRIORITY: